Jacob Hukill

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Research and Teaching Fields

Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Economics of Education

Education

University of Notre Dame — Notre Dame, IN
Ph.D. in Economics — May 2026 (exp)
Dissertation: *The Macroeconomics of Financing Higher Education*
Committee: Jeffrey Campbell (Chair), Zachary Stangebye, Jeffrey Denning
M.A. in Economics — 2024

Belmont University — Nashville, TN
B.Sc. in Economics and Political Science (Summa Cum Laude) — 2019

Job Market Paper

"Financing Human Capital Acquisition With Student Debt" — 2025

Abstract: I develop a life-cycle model of educational attainment, major choice, and student debt repayment to study how the structure and availability of student debt repayment plans impact human capital acquisition and the welfare of individuals. I first examine how the current system of income-driven repayment shapes both the decision to pursue college and the choice of major. I then evaluate the new Repayment Assistance Plan, comparing its effects on enrollment, major selection, repayment behavior, and welfare relative to the existing system.

Working Papers

"The Marginal Propensity to Consume Out of Student Debt Relief" — 2025

Abstract: I calculate the marginal propensity to consume student debt relief in a quantitative precautionary savings model. The fiscal expense of debt forgiveness is large and immediate, while the benefits free resources from recurring future debt payments, which reduces stimulus effects. In response to a one time transfer, the MPC is about 1.5 times higher when targeting indebted households rather than targeting all households. The MPCs of debt relief are less than one third that of one time cash transfers, and less than one fifth that of cash transfers to indebted individuals.

Teaching Experience

1. Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics I, University of Notre Dame — Fall 2024, Fall 2023, Fall 2022, Fall 2021
2. Teaching Assistant, Microeconomics II, University of Notre Dame — Spring 2025, Spring 2024, Spring 2023

Spring 2022

3. Instructor For Economics Summer Math Camp, University of Notre Dame 2023

2022

Honors and Awards

1. Graduating Senior Award 2019
2. John W. Burgess Award 2018
3. Belmont University Hale Leadership Award 2018

Technical Skills

Matlab, Julia, C++, CUDA, Python

References

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